

THEATRICAL PRESENTATIONS

The purpose of this policy is to identify and provide guidance on the principal's or designee's role in approving the two types of theatrical presentations that occur in schools: (1) official school-sponsored student presentations; and (2) non-school sponsored presentations.

A. Official School-Sponsored Presentations. The principal or designee's approval is required for any theatrical presentation, play, concert, artwork, or other performance to be held in, or at, an LCPS school facility.

1. The name and resources of a school are used to disseminate student expression in theatrical presentations, and such expression may be attributable to the school. Teachers will supervise the students and will include these presentations in all pertinent lesson and/or production plans. The principal or designee shall maintain editorial control over the selection, style, and content of all presentations.

2. The Superintendent shall develop and implement regulations for the presentation of theatrical productions presented as part of the public-school curriculum. Those guidelines shall be designed to support drama presentations that challenge, nurture, and extend student skills while adhering to the basic educational mission of teaching socially appropriate behavior, the rights and responsibilities of the exercise of free speech, and the importance of taking into consideration the sensibilities of the community. In accordance with the Code of Virginia, productions must not be harmful to juveniles. Theatrical productions that are deemed harmful to minors shall not be permitted. Theatrical productions must adhere to School Board Policies 5055 (Parental Notification of Instructional Materials with Sexually Explicit Content) and 5420 (Controversial and Sensitive Curriculum Standards), and Regulations 5420-A (Instructional and Communication Practices for Sensitive and Controversial Standards), School Board Regulation 5420-B, (Instructional Guidance for Use of Role-Play, Simulations and Assuming Different Perspectives), and School Board Regulation 5420-C, (Instructional Guidance Using Materials with Racial Slurs, Hate Speech, and Sensitive Content). The Theatre Arts production sponsor has the primary responsibility for ensuring that this policy is followed. However, the principal has the final authority in all decisions.

B. Non-School Sponsored Presentations. The principal's or designee's approval is required prior to a permit being granted under School Board Policy 6310 (Facility Use) for any theatrical presentation, play, concert, artwork, or other performance to be held in, or at, an LCPS school facility.

[Formerly Policy 8-42]

Adopted: 6/14/05

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Leg Ref: Code of Virginia [§18.2-390\(6\)](#)

Cross Refs: School Board Policies [5055](#) (Parental Notification of Instructional Materials with

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Sexually Explicit Content) and [5420](#) (Controversial and Sensitive Curriculum Standards); Regulations [5420-A-REG](#) (Instructional and Communication Practices for Sensitive and Controversial Standards), [5420-B-REG](#) (Instructional Guidance for Use of Role-Play, Simulations and Assuming Different Perspectives), [5420-C-REG](#) (Instructional Guidance Using Materials with Racial Slurs, Hate Speech, and Sensitive Content), Regulation [8310-REG](#) (Theatrical Presentations), and Policy [6310](#) (Facility Use)